Anurag

1615, 21 AVE NW, CALGARY, AB, T2M1M2
587-581-7674 • ANURAG1@YORKU.CA • WWW.DRANURAG.CA

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Assistant Professor-Teaching (Limited Term) **2026-present**
Department of Communication and Media Studies, York University

Sessional Course Instructor
Department of Communication, Media, and Film, University of Calgary **2024**

Teaching Assistant **2021-2025**
Department of Communication, Media and Film, University of Calgary

EDUCATION

PhD in Media and Communication Studies **2021-2026**
Department of Communication, Media, and Film, University of Calgary (UofC), Canada
Dissertation title: "Democracy on Airplane Mode: Law, Policy, and Governance in Internet Shutdowns in Kashmir and Manipur" (Committee: Dr. Gregory Taylor, Dr. Tamara Shepherd, Dr. Robin Mansell)

MA in Communication (First Division with Distinction) **2019**
University of Hyderabad, India

BA LLB (Hons.), First Division **2017**
School of Law, India

PUBLICATIONS

- Anurag & Gregory Taylor (2025); Beyond Buzzwords: 5G Wireless and Socio-Economic Empowerment in Rural India, Mobile Media & Communication (Under Review)
- Anurag. "Starlink in India: Connectivity, Control, and the Politics of the Sky" Tech Policy Press, 2025
- Anurag. "Silencing Bytes: An Investigation into the Intersection of Internet Shutdowns and Misinformation" Canadian Radio-Television and Telecommunications Commission (CRTC), June 20, 2024
- Mansell et al. (2025) Information Ecosystems and Troubled Democracy: A Global Synthesis of the State of Knowledge on New Media, AI and Data Governance. International Observatory on Information and Democracy. Paris.

HONORS, AWARDS AND GRANTS

President Award from the 12th President of India	2012
Graduate Conference Travel Award, Department of Communication, UofC ($500)	2026
Graduate Students Association Quality Money (for Grad College) ($16000)	2026
Images of Research Award, Faculty of Graduate Studies, UofC ($200)	2026
Canadian Communication Association Travel Grant ($1000)	2025
Graduate Conference Travel Award, Department of Communication, UofC ($550)	2025
International Communication Association (ICA) Travel Grant ($700 USD)	2025
Student Activity Fund (SAF), Centre for Career and Personal Development ($500)	2025

Transdisciplinary Scholarship (Connector Grant), UofC ($6000)	2025
Graduate College Graduate Award, UofC ($2500)	2025
Graduate Students Association Quality Money (for Grad College) ($6000)	2025
David B. Mitchell Graduate Scholarship, University of Calgary ($1200)	2024
CRTC-CCA Prize for Excellence in Policy Research, Gov. of Canada ($2000)	2024
Canadian Communication Association Travel Grant ($1000)	2024
Student Activity Fund (SAF), Centre for Career and Personal Development ($500)	2024
Images of Research Award, Faculty of Graduate Studies, UofC ($200)	2024
University of Calgary Teaching Award, Taylor Institute, UofC	2023
Graduate Conference Travel Award, Department of Communication, UofC ($500)	2024
Graduate Travel Conference Award, Department of Communication, UofC ($500)	2023
Graduate Labor Union Advocacy Award, University of Calgary ($200)	2023
SICSS Annenberg School of Communication, UPenn Grant, ($700 USD)	2022
International Graduate Tuition Award ($14,220)	2021-2025
Graduate College Conference Travel Grant, University of Calgary	2023
University Grants Commission National Eligibility Test (NET-JRF)	2021
Shastri Fellowship 2019 by Shastri Indo Canadian Institute ($4500)	2019

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, Department of Communication and Media Studies **2026**
York University
CMDS 3645: Advocacy, Social Change and Media: Discourses and Rhetorical Perspectives
CMDS 3661: Persuasive Campaigns
CMDS: Critical Approaches to Data Analysis and Visualization

Sessional Course Instructor, Department of Communication, Media, and Film **2024**
University of Calgary | *COMS 203: New Media (Spring 2024)*
Designed and delivered course materials and lectures; assessed student performance through assignments, exams, and presentations; provided individual and group feedback; facilitated classroom discussions that encouraged critical thinking; and mentored students and provided academic support.

Teaching Assistant, University of Calgary **2021-2025**
COMS 201: Introduction to Communication and Media Studies (Winter 2022, Fall 2023, Winter 2024, Fall 2025)
COMS 371: Critical Media Studies (Fall 2022)
Led weekly tutorials building on lecture material and encouraging student discussion; graded assignments, exams, and presentations; offered feedback to help students strengthen their work; held office hours for one-on-one academic support; worked with the instructor to maintain consistent grading and course delivery.

Invited Speaker, Department of Communication, Media, and Film **2026**
University of Calgary
Invited Speaker, COMS 313: Communication Research Methods (Instructor: Dr. Tamara Shepherd) Guest lectured on qualitative research interviews with human participants, covering ethical considerations, informed consent, and best practices for working with human subjects.

Invited Speaker, Department of Communication, Media, and Film **2026**

University of Calgary
Invited speaker for COMS 601 for Interdisciplinary Approaches to Communications Studies to deliver guest lecture on navigating graduate school, offering strategies for balancing coursework, research, teaching, and personal well-being.

Guest Speaker, Department of Communication, Media, and Film **2024**
University of Calgary
Guest speaker for COMS 314 for Research Methods class of Dr. Gregory Taylor to talk about basics of field work and methods.

Guest Speaker, Department of Communication, Media, and Film **2024**
University of Calgary
Guest speaker for COMS 615 for Research Methods class of Dr. Jessalynn Keller to talk about research methods in political economy.

Guest Speaker, Department of Communication, Media, and Film **2023**
University of Calgary
Guest speaker for COMS 401 for Special Topics in Communication to talk about Social Movements in Global South through protest songs.

Guest Speaker, School of Interdisciplinary Studies, Durham College **2019**
Guest speaker for Professor Valerie Lapp class on "Global Impact on Fake News"

PAST WORK EXPERIENCE

Communication Specialist, University of Calgary **2022-2026**
Snyder Research Institute, Cumming Medicine School
Science communication and content writing, website development, data management, data analysis, PowerBi, Marketo

Technical Writer **2019-2021**
Created user guides, training manuals, IT documentation for industrial, engineering, and banking clients using MadCap Flare

Journalist, Deccan Chronicle **2019**
Reported on the environment, science and technology, education, and civic issues for Indian english daily

Research Intern, British Broadcasting Corporation (BBC) **2018**
Worked as research intern for the British Broadcasting Corporation's New Delhi bureau

Legal Researcher, Supreme Court of India **2015-2017**
Assisted Senior Advocate Atul Kumar in legal drafting, Special Leave Petitions (SLPs), Public Interest Litigations (PILs), Right to Information (RTIs) requests

Political Research Intern, Aam Aadmi Party **2014**
Political research intern for the Office of Dr. Rajmohan Gandhi in national elections

Legal Intern, Government of Uttar Pradesh Pollution Control Board **2014**
Legal intern for Senior Advocate Pradeep Mishra, counsel for the Uttar Pradesh Government Pollution Control Board

Legal Intern, Wildlife Trust of India **2013**
Worked as a legal intern at Wildlife Trust of India, an environmental non-profit

Research Experience

Doctoral Researcher **2021-2026**

Department of Communication, Media, and Film, University of Calgary

Researcher, Forum on Information and Democracy **2023-2024**

Worked in the Research Assessment Panel for a project titled *Information and Democracy Report* under the supervision of Dr. Robin Mansell.

Research Assistant, Department of Communication, Media, and Film **2023-2024**

University of Calgary (Project title: 5G in rural India)

Conducted literature review, interviews, data analysis, and summarized findings for research projects.

Conference Presentations, Workshops and Summer Schools

- *Internet Shutdowns and the Crisis of Journalism*, International Association for Media and Communication Research (IAMCR), Galway, 2026 (withdrawn due to visa delay)
- *Balancing Academic Presence and Graduate Student Well-Being*, (Roundtable), Canadian Communication Association (CCA), 2026
- *Legal Frameworks and Administrative Practice in India's Internet Shutdown Regime*, Canadian Communication Association (CCA), 2026
- MediAsia 2026: The 17th Asian Conference on Media, Communication & Film, Kyoto (withdrawn due to funding and visa limitations.)
- *Governance and Disconnection: Field Insights into Internet Shutdowns and Misinformation in Kashmir*, International Communication Association (ICA), Denver 2025
- *Commodifying Communication: The Case Study of Regulatory Challenges to Meta's Data Practices in India*, International Communication Association (ICA), Denver 2025
- *5G in India: Rhetoric, Realities, and the Roadblocks to Digital Inclusion*, Canadian Communication Association (CCA), 2025
- Oxford Internet Institute Summer Doctoral Programme (SDP), 2025 (Rejected due to lack of funds)
- *"Law and Order: A Study of Legal Shifts in Internet Shutdown Regulations"*, Delhi School on Political Communication, 2024
- "*Beyond Buzzwords: A Review of Government, Corporate, and Consultancy Recommendations on 5G*", CMF Grad Conference, University of Calgary, 2024
- "*Dissecting Misinformation in a Digital Vacuum: Understanding the relationship between misinformation and internet shutdowns in India.*" Canadian Communication Association (CCA), University de Montreal, 2024
- "*Defund" in American Politics: Evaluating media discourse surrounding the mandate to "defund" in the 21st Century*, Annenberg School of Communication UPenn, 2023

Professional Service and Volunteering

Canadian Communication Association Board (Student Representative) **2024-2026**

Presented the Graduate Student Report to the CCA Board; organized Grad Caucus;

facilitated elections; coordinated faculty roundtables; and hosted student socials.

Grad Student Representative **2024-2025**
Faculty Tenure and Promotion Committee, University of Calgary
Represented Grad Student Association at the FTPC and gave feedback on faculty profiles

Student Mentor **2024-present**
Bluebird Mentorship, Nalanda Academy
Mentoring students from the lower caste (Dalit) community for foreign education.

Editor **2017-2019**
University of Hyderabad Magazine- Vantage
Editing, Content Planning, Article Selection, Writer Management for the University of Hyderabad's magazine.

Founder and President **2023-2026**
Ambedkar Students' Association, University of Calgary
Student's Group and study circle to create awareness and foster a safe and inclusive environment for caste-marginalized (Dalit) students in Alberta.

Volunteer **2021-2022**
Bike Root, University of Calgary
Worked as a bike mechanic for the university bike club to promote sustainable transport.

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

Academic Honesty Committee **2026-2027**
York University
Review and support academic misconduct cases and contribute to the development of academic integrity policies and procedures.

Course Ethics Review Committee **2026-2027**
York University
Review course-related ethical concerns and ensure compliance with institutional ethical and academic policies.

Graduate College Executive Committee **2024-2026**
University of Calgary
As an executive member, help create a vibrant community for graduate students and postdocs to enhance their professional development and leadership skills during their stay at UofC.

Graduate College EDI Committee **2024-2024**
University of Calgary
As an EDI committee member, I worked to advocate for underrepresented groups and improve EDI policies with senior leadership of college.

Graduate Labor Union Representative **2022-2024**
University of Calgary
As a Graduate Labor Union Representative, I actively worked to educate members about their labor rights through workshops, informational sessions, and one-on-one consultations.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- International Communication Association (ICA)
- International Association for Media and Communication Research (IAMCR)
- Canadian Communication Association (CCA)

REFERENCES

Dr. Gregory Taylor, Assoc. Professor, Department of Communication, Media and Film, University of Calgary, (403) 220-6206, gregory.taylor2@ucalgary.ca

Dr. Robin Mansell, Professor Emerita, Department of Media and Communications, London School of Economics, r.e.mansell@lse.ac.uk

Dr. Tamara Shepherd, Assoc. Professor, Department of Communication, Media and Film, University of Calgary, tamara.shepherd@ucalgary.ca

Dr. Sara Bannerman, Professor Department of Communication Studies and Media Arts, McMaster University banners@mcmaster.ca